

these things on your commute, you will get a schedule in order that you wouldn't even realise becoming a part of your daily lives.

SMART TECH

Whether you use HomePod by Apple or other assistant devices by Google and Amazon that are available on the market, they're all a great starting point for your smart home setup. Once you have chosen the base platform, you can start buying products with interoperability with your platform inbuilt. You could start with something simple like a smart plug to control an older dumb device or appliance from your phone. This could be for something as simple as turning on the kettle for tea as you're reaching home. You could also start your washing machine at the opportune time to have freshly washed laundry to hang up as you reach home, or an air condi-



Let me start baking that pizza...

tioner to arrive home to a comfortably cooled or heated home. More importantly, you could use smart cameras, or doorbells to attend to deliveries while you're away from home, and use two way communication to even talk to them. Very useful when you're running a tad late and that courier you've been waiting desperately for shows up. Now you could ask them to wait for a few minutes instead of rearranging a delivery time.

Of course there are a plethora of other things you could do as well, with everything from smart TVs to fridges, cameras, speakers and more, and your imagination is the only limiting factor.

SWITCH OR DECK IT UP!

You may have seen this one coming but for geeks, there is nothing better than squeezing in a round or two of your favourite game during your

commutes. Well, there is no harm in gifting yourself a Nintendo Switch, or we hear talks that Steam Deck could land in India soon, so you could get one of those if you want to.



The Switch is a 5-year-old portable console that had come in as a replacement for the fabled Wii U and 3DS from Nintendo. Despite its age, it is clear that Nintendo plans to continue supporting it for a long time from now. At least in technology years. Even if Nintendo plans to make a newer console, the indications are that there will be backwards compatibility, so you should be set for some time. There is an extensive library of games that is available on the Switch for you to look into, and if you are running short on cash and still want the Nintendo experience, then you can also consider getting the Nintendo Switch Lite. As for the Steam Deck, the international reviews look promising. However, we can't make any promises unless we get the unit in hand. But you can hope to see the Deck being listed on Steam's India portal soon.

TOOL IT UP

If you travel using your own mode of transport, say a motorcycle, an electric scooter, or a bicycle, one of the best recommendations for you is



NOT THE CHAMPION... Get the Champ

to invest in a multi-tool. Yes, it might not be the geekiest of things on first look, but it is extremely practical and is something that you can flaunt whenever and wherever you want, looking like Keanu Reeves in speed wedging open an elevator door! And... They also come in handy for multiple purposes. They come with a pliers, a scissor, a serrated knife, and even a pen!

We have three different recommendations for you. If you are looking to spend a little bit, then you can go for the Leatherman 831426 Wingman Multitool or the Victorinox Swiss Champ Multitool. Keep in mind it is the Champ, and not a Champion. Both these multi tools come in around the ₹7,000 mark and are available in India on multiple major ecommerce stores. If you are on a budget, and do not want to spend that amount of money, then you can also look at the Bosch 12-in-1 Metal and Plastic Tool Plier Set. It comes in at a tenth of the price of the offerings from Victorinox or Leatherman. But keep in mind, that the reduction in price comes in with a reduction in quality too.

DO NOTHING

Yeah, you read it right. Before or after an intense day of work or school, it is important to keep your mind clear and uncluttered. Instead of overloading your brain with tech, maybe you want to *do nothing*. If a blank mind seems impossible to do, spend time isolating your mind at least. Read a book, listen to your favourite tunes, do some planning, make a to-do list, or just work on yourself. All of these things you can do when in public transport, including dozing off for a short power nap.

Obviously if you're the one driving you cannot do any of that as you need to pay attention to the road and traffic. You can still work on yourself by listening to podcasts, or an audio book, and something we don't do enough of, is catching up with family. There's nothing like using the boredom of a commute alone in a car to catch up with family members or friends who you don't get to spend enough time talking to. **d**